

The Growth Path

One climbs up the designation ladder by acquiring relevant experience and knowledge in the domain. The nomenclature of these designations differs from company to company. The average industry benchmark is Rs 2 to 2.5 lakh per annum for freshers.

Designation	Salary per annum (Rs)	Relevant Experience (Years)
Director of Engineering	66 lakhs and above	8 - 10
Project Lead/Manager	48 - 64 lakh	6 - 7
Lead Designer	24 - 42 lakh	4 - 5
Senior Designer	6 -12 lakh	2 - 3
Fresher	2.4 - 4.8 lakh	NA



While hiring designing talents, we look for... the individual's demonstrativeness, creativity, innovativeness, and passion for designing"

Praveen Vishakantaiah
Senior Manager
Digital Enterprise
Group, Intel India
Development Center

or getting one's hands on design tools. The initial training period ranges from six weeks to a year, depending on the company and their area of operations.

Rahul Arya, Marketing Director—India and Saarc, Cadence Design Systems, says, "At Cadence, we have a well-structured assimilation programme, which includes gap analysis (a business assessment tool for comparison of actual performance with the potential performance). In addition, all freshers have a 'mentor' assigned to them, who guides the new employee through his or her first few weeks at Cadence, to make the assimilation process quick and smooth."

Training programs are undertaken at various levels. For example, specific orientation happens for freshers in terms of the RTL (Register Transfer Level) languages, RTL coding guidelines, and specific tool usage. During the technical training, designers have to work on circuit designs, circuit layouts, signal processing (analogue, digital, mixed), chip architecture, logics, etc.

"Organisations mostly focus on EDA (Electronic Design Automation) tool training to provide insights into chip design, and undertake training programmes in partnership with specialist companies like Cadence, Magma, Synopsis, Mentor and others," says Praveen Acharya, VP, Semiconductor Solution Group, KPIT Cummins Infosystems Ltd.

Multinational companies such as Texas Instruments, Intel, AMD, Broadcom, Cadence and others send promising freshers as well as experienced employees for training or work on projects outside India. Designers thus get to enhance their skills. Companies like Intel believe that their design engineers should be exposed to corporate culture as well.

Summing It Up

Wipro has more than 1,450 chip designers, Sasken has 350, and ARM India has 200 engineers—and they're all looking for more. According to a report by The ISA and Frost & Sullivan, the semiconductor and embedded industry is projected to bloom from \$3.25 billion in 2005 to \$43.7 billion by 2015. There's already a dearth of highly-skilled chip design engineers, and the needs are only going to rise—which works out perfect for interested candidates. The future of Indian chip designers looks good, and we're already getting our space on the global map. Don't get left behind! ■

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